Microsoft Teams troubleshooting

Article KB0010070 | Owner: Messaging & Collaboration | Subcategory: Microsoft Teams | Applies to: Windows 11 23H2/24H2 (Dell Latitude 5440/7440, Lenovo ThinkPad T14/X1 Carbon, HP EliteBook 840), macOS 14/15 (MacBook Pro/Air), Microsoft Teams desktop client (managed via Intune Company Portal), Teams web client, Acme Global Microsoft 365 tenant

Summary

This article guides Acme Global employees and service-desk agents through common Microsoft Teams problems such as the client failing to load, audio drop-outs, screen-share failures, and presence status stuck on "Away". It provides preliminary checks, a user self-help procedure to clear the Teams cache and update the client, a dedicated agent troubleshooting workflow, and verification steps to confirm resolution.

Symptoms

- Teams application hangs on a blank white screen or shows "We're having trouble connecting to Teams"
- During a meeting, microphone or speaker produces no audio, or others cannot hear you
- Screen-share button is greyed out or sharing starts but participants see a black screen
- Your presence indicator remains "Away" even when you are active, and manual status changes do not persist

Common causes

- Corrupted local Teams cache files (%AppData%\[Microsoft\]Teams on Windows or ~/Library/Application Support/Microsoft/Teams on macOS)
- Outdated Teams client version missing recent bug fixes
- Missing macOS screen-recording permission in System Settings -> Privacy & Security
- Network restrictions caused by VPN split-tunnel or GlobalProtect certificate issues
- Presence sync delays due to Exchange Online calendar conflicts or cached status

Preliminary Checks

Before proceeding with deeper troubleshooting, verify the basics that often resolve Teams issues quickly. Ensure the device is connected to the ACME-Corp Wi-Fi (802.1X) or, if remote, that the Pulse Secure/Palo Alto GlobalProtect VPN is active with a valid certificate. Confirm that the user can sign in to the Teams web client at https://teams.microsoft.com; if the web client works, the problem is likely local to the desktop app. Finally, check for any pending Windows or macOS updates that might affect audio/video drivers.

Self-Help Procedure (Clear Cache & Update)

Follow these steps to reset the Teams client and ensure you are running the latest version. This resolves most loading, audio, and screen-share problems without requiring administrator intervention.

1. Close Microsoft Teams completely: right-click the Teams icon in the system tray (Windows) or menu bar (macOS) and select Quit.
2. On Windows, press Win+R, type %appdata%\Microsoft\Teams, and press Enter. On macOS, open Finder, choose Go -> Go to Folder, enter ~/Library/Application Support/Microsoft/Teams, and click Go.
3. Delete the contents of the folder (select all items, press Shift+Delete to bypass the Recycle Bin/Trash). Do not delete the folder itself.
4. Restart the computer to clear any locked files.
5. After reboot, open the Company Portal app, locate Microsoft Teams under Apps, and click Update if an update is available. If no update appears, download the latest Teams installer from https://teams.microsoft.com/downloads and run it.
6. Launch Teams, sign in with your Acme Global credentials, and test the previously reported issue.

Agent Troubleshooting Workflow

When a ticket arrives, the Messaging & Collaboration L2 team should follow this structured approach. Begin by confirming the user's environment and gathering logs, then apply targeted fixes based on symptoms.

1. Verify the user's device compliance status in Intune (Managed Devices -> Device name -> Compliance). Non-compliant devices may lack required certificates or policies affecting Teams.

2. Ask the user to reproduce the issue while you monitor the Teams debug logs: Ctrl+Shift+Alt+1 (Windows) or Option+Shift+Command+L (macOS) to generate a .log file on the desktop.
3. If the log shows "Failed to load module" or "Cache corruption", proceed with the cache-clear steps outlined in the self-help procedure.
4. For audio problems, check that the correct audio device is selected in Teams -> Settings -> Devices and that the device is not muted or disabled in the OS sound settings.
5. For screen-share failures on macOS, navigate to System Settings -> Privacy & Security -> Screen Recording and ensure Microsoft Teams is toggled on; prompt the user to grant permission if missing.
6. After applying a fix, ask the user to test the specific symptom (loading, audio, share, status) and confirm resolution.

Verification

After troubleshooting, perform these checks to ensure the issue is truly resolved before closing the ticket.

1. Confirm that Teams launches within 5 seconds and displays the recent chat/list view without error messages.
2. Place a test call (Teams -> Calls -> Make a call) to a colleague and verify two-way audio.
3. Initiate a screen-share session in a meeting and have a participant confirm they can view the shared screen.
4. Manually set your presence to Available and observe that it stays Available for at least two minutes of activity.
5. Document the final Teams client version (Settings -> About) and note that it matches the latest version available in Company Portal.

Additional Tips & Known Issues

Certain recurring patterns have been observed at Acme Global. Keeping these in mind can speed up future resolutions.

- **VPN split-tunnel**: If GlobalProtect is configured to exclude Microsoft 365 traffic, Teams may fall back to a less-optimal path causing latency. Ensure the tunnel includes *.teams.microsoft.com and *.skype.com.
- **Exchange calendar sync**: A corrupted calendar cache can cause presence to show Away. Clearing the Outlook cache (%localappdata%\Microsoft\Outlook) sometimes helps.
- **Audio driver updates**: After Windows Patch Tuesday, audio drivers may need a reboot; remind users to restart if audio fails after updates.
- **MacOS Ventura 14+**: The screen-recognition permission prompt may appear only after a Teams update; advise users to check Privacy settings after each upgrade.

When to escalate

If the issue persists after performing the self-help cache clear, updating the Teams client, verifying macOS screen-recording permissions, and confirming network/VPN connectivity, escalate to the Messaging & Collaboration L2 support team. Include the Teams client version, the debug log generated via Ctrl+Shift+Alt+1 (Windows) or Option+Shift+Command+L (macOS), the device compliance status from Intune, and any exact error messages observed.

Keywords: Teams, Microsoft Teams, cache, audio, screen share, presence, away, loading, update, macOS screen recording